



Greek mythology comes to the small screen with *God of War: Chains of Olympus*, as Kratos hacks and slashes through scores of well-rendered enemies to deliver immense entertainment

Ever so often, you face a big baddie like a cyclops or the first boss, the Baslisk. Once you pummel these foes, you enter one of the series' hallmark mini-games, which are all about getting the timing right upon prompting. Each press of the indicated button will have Kratos launching himself on the foe, ripping out eyes, disembowling them, tearing off limbs, bashing in heads – it's all very red and satisfying!

The game isn't all muscle-bound mayhem, though. Sometimes, entire stages are well thought-up puzzles that will test your mental faculties. They're not too tough, so we suggest you figure them out rather than scurry for a walkthrough.

The graphics are the best on the PSP to date, with beautiful architecture complimented by some very life-like lighting. The enemy models are impressive, with plenty of enemies on screen to beat up; and the big baddies do look quite intimidating. All in all, the overpowering *Chains of Olympus* seem to pop out of the small screen.

While tons of fun, it is all sadly short-lived. A long afternoon is all it takes to get through the game, and will leave you wishing for more. Oh well, good things come in small packages and all that.

Chains of Olympus is the most perfect game on a handheld system. For those with a daily, long commute, here is the reason to buy a PSP. Just make sure you don't gouge out the eyes of the guy peeking over your shoulder.

Patapon

The idea of combining a rhythm-based gameplay into a strategy game seemed a bit strange at first when the game's associate producer Chris Hinojosa-Miranda first explained the concept: "You tap out a drum beat using the PSP's buttons and control your tribal warriors to execute manoeuvres."

It sounded terribly complex and not the kind of game that would appeal to many. But the developers at Pyramid Studios were undaunted and believed in their own ability. And are we glad they stuck with it...

Patapon changes the way you look at video games, uprooting base conceptions